

Little One Inch

Once long ago in Japan, there lived a couple who had no children.

They prayed to the gods for a child, even one as small as a finger, and finally their prayers were answered.

The child born to them was so small that they named him Issun Boshi, meaning "Little One Inch."

When Issun Boshi reached the age of 15, he said goodbye to his parents and **set out for** Kyoto, the capital city, to **seek** his **fortune**.

In Kyoto, he found employment in a wealthy household.

He could not do much work because of his size, but his **diligence** and **sincerity pleased** his master and mistress.

Their daughter found him **delightful**.

One day, Issun Boshi **accompanied** the girl to the temple. On the way, two giants **leaped out** in front of them from behind some **bushes**.

Issun Boshi **deliberately drew their attention** to him so the girl could escape.

The giants became **furious**, and one of them picked him up and **swallowed** him.

Issun Boshi had a needle his mother had given him, which he wore around his waist.

Inside the giant's stomach, he took out the needle and began **stabbing** the stomach with it.

Then, climbing up the **gullet**, he entered the giant's mouth and caused **chaos** with his needle.

Frightened, the giant **spat him out**.

When the other giant **bent down** to look at him, Issun Boshi stabbed him in the eye.

The giants had had enough. They ran away, one holding a hand to his mouth and the other to his eye.

In their haste, they left behind a **mallet** which Issun Boshi and the girl — she had come back to help him — recognised as a magical object.

"You have to hit it on the ground and make a wish," said the girl.

So they hit the mallet on the ground and made a wish. The next moment, Issun Boshi had grown to normal size and stood **clad** in the **armour** of a samurai!

The girl's father **gladly** gave her in marriage to Issun Boshi, who proved a **devoted** husband.

He brought his parents to live with him too, and though they were happy to see their son so big, they still lovingly called him Issun Boshi.



Vocabulary

1. **Set out for** (phrase) – depart, leave, embark, begin a journey, head out यात्रा पर निकलना
2. **Seek** (verb) – search for, pursue, look for, try to obtain, strive for खोजना / प्रयास करना
3. **Fortune** (noun) – wealth, success, fate, destiny, prosperity भाग्य / सफलता
4. **Diligence** (noun) – hard work, persistence, dedication, perseverance, industriousness परिश्रम
5. **Sincerity** (noun) – honesty, genuineness, truthfulness, earnestness, frankness ईमानदारी / निष्ठा
6. **Please** (verb) – satisfy, delight, gratify, charm, impress प्रसन्न करना
7. **Delightful** (adjective) – charming, lovely, pleasing, joyful, appealing मनोहर / आनंददायक
8. **Accompany** (verb) – go with, escort, attend, join, follow साथ जाना
9. **Leap out** (phrasal verb) – jump out, spring out, emerge suddenly, burst out, pounce बाहर कूदना
10. **Bush** (noun) – shrub, plant, hedge, undergrowth, foliage झाड़ी
11. **Deliberately** (adverb) – intentionally, purposefully, knowingly, consciously, calculatedly जानबूझकर
12. **Draw one's attention** (phrase) – attract, catch, capture, direct focus, call attention ध्यान आकर्षित करना
13. **Furious** (adjective) – angry, enraged, mad, infuriated, wrathful क्रोधित
14. **Swallow** (verb) – gulp, ingest, devour, consume, take in निगलना
15. **Stab** (verb) – pierce, jab, thrust, poke, impale चुभोना / घोंपना
16. **Gullet** (noun) – throat, esophagus, food pipe, windpipe, pharynx गला / भोजन नली
17. **Chaos** (noun) – disorder, confusion, mayhem, turmoil, havoc अराजकता
18. **Frighten** (verb) – scare, terrify, startle, intimidate, unnerve डराना
19. **Spit out** (phrasal verb) – eject, expel, vomit, throw out, discharge थूक देना / बाहर निकालना
20. **Bend down** (phrasal verb) – stoop, crouch, hunch, bow, lean नीचे झुकना
21. **In one's haste** (phrase) – in a hurry, hurriedly, quickly, rashly, without care जल्दबाजी में

22. **Mallet** (noun) – hammer, club, maul,
wooden beater, gavel लकड़ी का हथौड़ा

23. **Clad** (noun) – dressed, covered, arrayed,
robed, attired पहना हुआ / पोशाकयुक्त

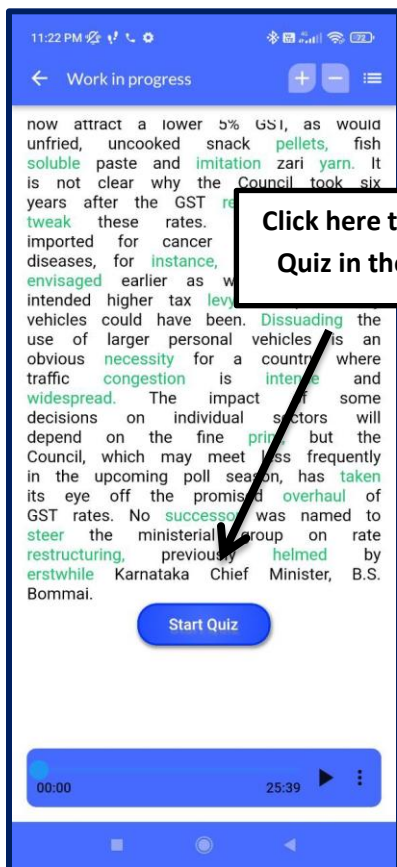
24. **Armour** (noun) – protective covering,
shield, suit of defense, plating, safeguard
कवच / हथियारबंद वस्त्र

25. **Gladly** (adverb) – happily, willingly,
joyfully, cheerfully, eagerly खुशी-खुशी

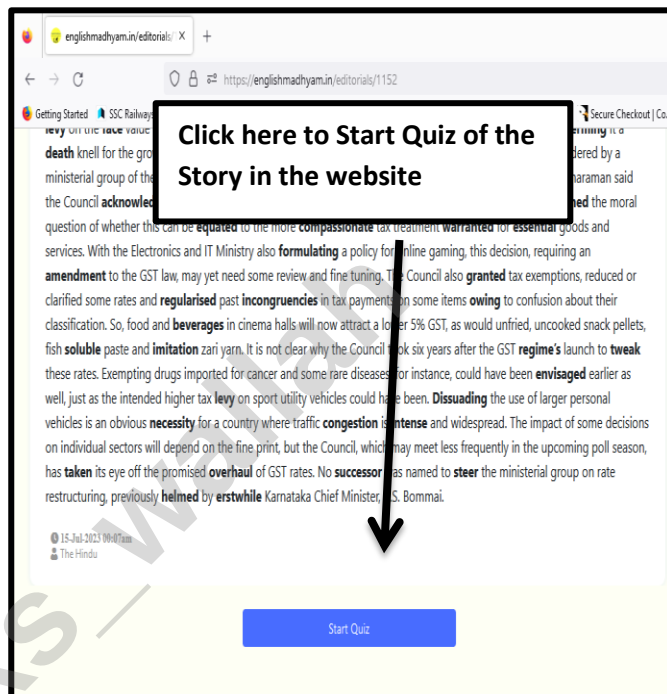
26. **Devoted** (adjective) – loyal, dedicated,
loving, faithful, committed समर्पित /
निष्ठावान

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